who needn’t do so. On the one hand, a heightened sense of insecurity, on the other hand, an uncommon readiness to confront it.

In an interesting, perhaps last, interview, Kissinger expressed his skepticism regarding the two-state solution. Gaza could have been a model for the two-state solution, after it had been vacated by Israel in 2005, but instead became what it became. Kissinger saw no feasible solution other than having Jordan rule the West Bank. In my opinion, the former secretary of state’s skepticism has good ground, but his solution is questionable. It is anybody’s guess whether Jordan would accept the poisoned gift of a West Bank, with its extremists. As for Gaza, what would happen to it? I repeat that the only reasonable solution, after a lengthy de-escalation process under a Palestinian authority, with control of security by an international body in which the US would have a major role, is the setting up of an independent Palestinian state.

Why do I believe that a Palestinian state can eventually see the light of day? Because there manifestly is a national feeling among Palestinians, a feeling strong enough to preclude the acceptance of foreign rule, either Jordanian or Egyptian, not to mention Israeli.

The major obstacles will be Palestinian extremism (Hamas) and Israeli extremism (the settlers). I am told that Ben-Gvir makes sure that weapons are being distributed to the settlers “for their defense.” Five hundred thousand settlers armed to the teeth will make any de-escalation process lengthy and difficult, with, from the outset, an exterritorial status for the settlements. A further obstacle may be the overall shift in Israeli politics from the center-left to the center-right, which means that there is very little support for the creation of a Palestinian state.

One of the Houthis’ enemies organized an explosion in a shed where they keep armaments. Nonetheless, Israel’s main shipping company redirected all its traffic around the Cape of Good Hope. That will lead to a serious increase in prices for a whole range of commodities.